8

Outlook 2026-2027

Key Takeaways

1

Three gaps define the roadmap: merchant acceptance, standardization, and rails-agnostic routing.

2

Brazil's FX reclassification is the regulatory template the region will study.

3

The standout finding: operators at opposite ends of the stack have independently converged on the same architecture, optimal-rail routing under unified compliance.

Spotting the Gaps

Merchant acceptance

The holding-to-spending transition remains incomplete because **the infrastructure connecting stablecoins to traditional payment rails is still maturing**; expansion beyond crypto-native businesses requires payment processors and issuers that can support stablecoin-funded payments while allowing merchants to continue receiving settlement in their preferred currency without taking on digital-asset risk (Source: Pomelo company data).

Card-linked stablecoin volume, though the second-fastest-growing category globally, **remains small in absolute terms at roughly $4.5 billion of 2025's real-payment total** (Source: Stablecoin Insider analysis of McKinsey/Artemis data).



Standardization

Across Latin America, regulatory frameworks are becoming more mature, giving financial institutions greater confidence to build stablecoin-based products; **the next challenge is ensuring that compliance, reporting, settlement, and risk-management capabilities evolve at the same pace as adoption**, making stablecoin-powered financial services as reliable and predictable as traditional payment infrastructure (Source: Pomelo company data).

Rails-agnostic routing: the standout finding

Operators at opposite ends of the stack reached the same conclusion independently. A regulated settlement network:

> *The winning model is not stablecoin-only or traditional-only. It is the one that routes each transaction through the optimal rail under a single compliance standard*
>
> Source: Movantis company data

A card issuer-processor, analysing a different layer entirely:

> ***The winners are not forcing users to choose one rail over another.*** *They are building infrastructure that makes the choice invisible, intelligently routing transactions through the most efficient path based on geography, user type, transaction size, and business model.*
>
> Source: Pomelo company data

When a remittance network and a card platform converge on identical architecture without coordination, that architecture is the market's direction: optimal-rail routing under unified compliance is the design pattern of 2026-2027.

Which corridors open next

Expect the SMB-driven broadening of Asia-Latam to continue: growth in this period will come not only from enterprise volume but from a wider base of smaller players who previously had no access at all (Source: VelaFi company data). **Trade operators expect the same broadening on the demand side**: as settlement friction disappears, adoption spreads from the companies that needed stablecoins to survive dollar scarcity toward companies that simply want faster procurement cycles (Source: Mandioca company data).

On the labour side, **the trajectory is mainstreaming rather than expansion**: stablecoin payroll continues moving beyond crypto-native firms into agencies, startups, and conventional global businesses, because it works better for international teams regardless of industry (Source: Rise company data). Intra-Latam is the largest untapped family, with stablecoins positioned as the settlement bridge between national instant-payment systems as Bre-B scales and PIX pursues cross-border links (Source: FiscalNote).

Bolivia's potential formal recognition of USDT would create the region's first officially stablecoin-integrated national payment framework, a precedent other dollar-constrained economies would study closely (Source: Coin Insider)

The regulatory trajectory

Three vectors dominate:



Brazil's FX reclassification

Brazil's FX reclassification (Resolutions 519/520/521, plus Resolution 561's eFX stablecoin ban from October 2026) is the template other central banks will study: it absorbs stablecoins into the supervised FX system rather than banning or blessing them, with licensing, reporting, and tax consequences attached (Source: Plasma).

AML/KYB pressure intensifies

AML/KYB pressure intensifies region-wide, alongside provider consolidation and growing institutional entry from banks and larger corporates through 2026-2027 (Source: VelaFi company data).

International spillover

International spillover continues: GENIUS Act and MiCA reserve/licensing baselines increasingly shape Latam frameworks, while Mexico's pending legislation would add a peso-stablecoin regime across ten financial laws (Source: Legal Paradox).

What consolidation looks like

The corridor consolidates around operators who make compliance and local knowledge invisible, a harder moat than a faster rail (Source: VelaFi company data). Regulated standing on both ends of a corridor is built over years, not bought with capital, and stablecoins run on top of that requirement rather than removing it (Source: Movantis company data). Brazil's rule barring licensed institutions from transacting with unauthorised counterparties after 30 October 2026 will mechanically force consolidation there (Source: Conduit). Expect licensed, multi-corridor, rails-agnostic operators to absorb single-corridor technology providers, and expect banks entering the market to buy their way in through exactly these platforms.

The bottom line

Latin America spent a decade being described as a crypto adoption story. The data assembled in this report describes something else: a settlement infrastructure story.

The region's largest market conducts virtually all of its crypto activity in dollar tokens; the fastest-growing use case is business supplier payments rather than trading; central banks are writing the tokens into FX law rather than banning them; and every layer of the stack, from trade settlement to corridors to cards to payroll to regulated networks, reports the same three wins: speed, dollar access, and working capital.

Users don't think about blockchain, and the last mile stays on regulated local rails. The infrastructure has become invisible, which is how you know it has become infrastructure.

FAQs

FAQS

How big is the Latam stablecoin market in 2026?

Latin America recorded ~$1.5 trillion in cumulative crypto volume between July 2022 and June 2025, and $324 billion moved via stablecoins in 2025 alone, an 89% year-on-year increase (Sources: Chainalysis; GO Markets).

Why do Latam businesses use stablecoins instead of banks?

Speed and dollar access, not fees: Mandioca's trade-settlement data shows settlement compressing from 2-5 business days to minutes, pre-funded accounts eliminated, and businesses in dollar-scarce or volatile-currency markets gaining reliable access to dollar-denominated value (Source: Mandioca company data).

Which country leads stablecoin adoption in Latam?

Brazil, with $318.8 billion in crypto value received in the last measured 12-month period and over 90% of flows stablecoin-related, per the country's central bank (Source: Chainalysis).

Do stablecoins replace local payment systems like PIX?

No. In production systems, stablecoins carry the cross-border and interbank settlement leg, while regulated local rails (PIX, SPEI, CVU, Nequi, Bre-B) handle origination and last-mile disbursement (Source: Movantis company data).

Are stablecoins regulated in Latin America?

Increasingly, yes. Brazil classifies stablecoin operations as foreign-exchange transactions under central bank Resolutions 519/520/521 (effective February 2026) with mandatory VASP licensing; Argentina requires CNV registration; Mexico's peso-stablecoin legislation is pending; Bolivia is evaluating formal USDT recognition (Sources: ANBIMA; HackenProof; Legal Paradox; Coin Insider).

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MANDIOCA

Cross-border payments facilitator connecting Latin America to global markets, helping importers/exporters move money via stablecoins. $1B+ processed, offices in the US, El Salvador, Hong Kong, and Colombia.

MOVANTIS

Movantis is a unified financial infrastructure platform for real-time cross-border payments across Latin America. Joined Circle Payments Network to add stablecoin settlement to its network, which moves $63B+ annually.

POMELO

Pomelo is an API-first card issuing and payments platform for banks and fintechs worldwide, issuing across 150+ countries with deep roots in Latin America. Clients include BBVA, Santander, and Binance.

RISE

Global payroll platform paying contractors and employees in local currency or stablecoins (USDC/USDT). $1.3B+ processed across 190+ countries, with over half of withdrawals now in stablecoins.

VELAFI

VelaFi is a stablecoin-powered financial infrastructure platform for global businesses, providing on/off ramps, pay-ins and pay-outs, cross-border payments, multi-currency accounts, FX services, liquidity and treasury tools, and secure custody, available directly on the platform or through API integrations.

About Stablecoin Insider

Stablecoin Insider is the leading source for news, data, and expert insights on stablecoins and the future of blockchain-based finance. As global interest in stable digital currencies accelerates, we deliver in-depth, independent reporting on the technologies, platforms, policies, and real-world use cases driving stablecoin adoption worldwide.

Stablecoin Insider works closely with companies across the stablecoin and digital payments stack to help them increase visibility, credibility, and discoverability. On a journey to be the go-to knowledge hub for professionals in the stablecoin space serving the space through articles, reports, interviews, collaborations, and events.



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stablecoininsider.org
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